PRINCIPLE II: AI-ASSISTED LANGUAGE EDUCATION SHOULD BE RESPONSIBLE

Guideline 3

Promote social justice, linguistic and cultural diversity

About this guideline

Just like other learning materials (Apple, 1992), AI systems encode structural hierarchies in language education. They reflect the priorities, blind spots and power structures of the contexts in which they were designed, and the languages, cultures and epistemologies that dominate their training data. In language education, where questions of identity, belonging and linguistic diversity are central, this is not an abstract concern. Guideline 3 therefore calls on language teachers to move beyond unreflective adoption of AI tools, towards a critically informed and transformative practice that actively uses AI as a lever for greater equity and inclusion.

Artificial intelligence holds both promise and risk for **linguistic diversity**. Power disparities between languages, linguistic varieties, and linguistic communities are well documented in the literature (e.g., Pennycook, 2021; Phillipson, 1992; Rosa, 2019). Artificial intelligence can counteract this potential bias by providing easier access to authentic or adapted materials in languages for which published learning resources may not be available. However, the uncritical use of AI in language education may amplify such disparities, as **large language models** (LLMs) tend to privilege languages (and varieties within languages) with high online visibility and status in AI output (Navigli et al., 2023), whereas under-resourced languages, including heritage languages, may be entirely absent. Challenging such bias might involve deliberately prompting AI tools in ways that surface marginalised languages, varieties and perspectives. It could also involve greater awareness of, and transparency about, the language varieties used as a model during accuracy-focused work, or a broader range of corrective alternatives.

AI tools do not enter language classrooms free of **cultural bias**: the datasets on which large language models are trained tend to reflect the norms of dominant social groups, which could exacerbate processes of cultural hegemony and epistemic injustice (Fricker, 2007; Resnik, 2025; Stracke, 2024). When this goes unrecognised, and language education is further reduced to instrumental goals, learners' identities and cultural capital risk marginalisation (Angelo, 2021; Atari et al., 2023; Helm et al., 2024). With appropriate training and resources, teachers who approach AI output critically, rather than as "objective" or "authoritative", are well placed to resist these tendencies, and to design AI-assisted activities that connect to established traditions of critical language pedagogy by actively affirming learners' cultural and linguistic repertoires (Jeon et al., 2025; Krulatz et al., 2018; Norton & Toohey, 2011).

Ensuring that AI-supported language education remains **socially just** also depends on the availability of technological infrastructure as well as the equitable and sustainable participation in digitally mediated learning environments, as described in the UN Sustainable Development Goals (United

Nations, 2015). This involves addressing infrastructure barriers, such as disparities in access to electricity and high-speed internet (Bird et al., 2020; Broadband Commission for Sustainable Development, 2020), as well as barriers related to teachers' and learners' beliefs, digital confidence and opportunities for sustained training (Fuller, 1969; George et al., 2006; Venkatesh, 2022). To that end, developing the teachers' Technological Pedagogical Content Knowledge (TPACK; Mishra & Koehler, 2006) constitutes an important step that enables educators to exercise informed professional judgment, critically evaluate AI tools, and design contextually responsive pedagogies that mitigate inequity rather than reproduce it.

Did you know?

Even advanced large language models, which have been explicitly designed to reduce bias, may still exhibit bias implicitly. For example, they tend to associate negative language more often with Black individuals, they link women more frequently with the humanities rather than sciences, and they favour men in leadership contexts (Maslej et al., 2025).

Something to consider

This guidance is particularly relevant to language teachers working in Indigenous and community-based language revitalisation programmes. These settings, however, also raise additional considerations that fall outside the scope of this document. Some concerns include community sovereignty over language data, the near-total absence of such languages from LLM training corpora, and a heightened risk that uncritical AI use might normalise dominant norms where resisting them is the pedagogical purpose.

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Competences and reflection questions

3.1 I can use AI applications in ways that sustain linguistic diversity

Descriptor: *How effectively does my use of AI sustain or promote linguistic diversity?*

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Which languages and varieties are represented in the AI tools I use, and which are absent or poorly served?
- How do I ensure that feedback or resources reflect multiple linguistic varieties and registers?
- When I use AI for accuracy-focused feedback, do I specify which language variety or register is the target, and do I share that information transparently with learners?
- Is the AI output I use reproducing the same linguistic hierarchies I would challenge in a conventional textbook?
- How might instances of linguistic bias in AI output be treated as pedagogical opportunities?

3.2 I can mitigate algorithmic bias

Descriptor: *How vigilantly do I ensure that AI output in my class does not reproduce biases towards certain knowledge, voices and values?*

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Whose perspectives or interests are represented in the data that my AI tools rely on?
- What prompting strategies might I use to actively generate an inclusive range of perspectives, knowledge systems or cultural framings?
- What is my process for reviewing AI-generated content for bias before it reaches learners?
- How do I create space for learners to bring their own knowledge and cultural perspectives into dialogue with AI output?

3.3 I can ensure that the AI tasks I design are accessible to all learners

Descriptor: *How do I make sure that the AI tasks I design are accessible to all learners?*

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- What disparities in access to AI tools am I aware of in my context?
- How can I adapt my teaching to accommodate learners with limited access or skills?
- What resources or partnerships can I use to bridge these gaps?